TOP MODEL COMPOSITIONS

Suitable for Primary School Students

JERRY LEE

Contents

A Little Introduction….....2
Topic: An Unwelcomed Guest 3
Topic: Adapting to Change.....6
Topic: A Brave Rescue 8
Topic: Teamwork.....10
Topic: A Foolish Act 13
Topic: Trying Something New.....15
Topic: A Touching Moment.....18
Topic: A Foolish Dare.....20
Topic: An Argument.....23
Topic: Forgiveness 26
Topic: An Argument.....29
Topic: A Foolish Dare.....32
Topic: A Heart-Warming Experience.....34
Topic: An Unexpected Friendship.....36
Topic: Being a Leader 39
Topic: Learning a New Skill 41
Topic: A Courageous Act 43
Topic: An Argument.....45
Topic: Being Disrespectful 48
Does your child need help in his or her studies?.....52
You might find these pre-recorded online courses helpful!.....53

A Little Introduction…

I am Jerry Lee, Founder of **WritingSamurai.com** and Director at **Grade Solution Learning Centre**. WritingSamurai.com is an online learning platform where your child can learn from our pre-recorded online courses, while Grade Solution Learning Centre is for physical and live zoom classes - we have a branch at Bugis. To date, there are more than 10,000 enrolments on WritingSamurai.com and we serve more than 1000+ students at Grade Solution Learning Centre yearly.

To summarise our teaching methods, we simply teach your child to **write AWESOME compos without memorising bombastic words or phrases**. We have a lesson plan to guide your child from writing the intro all the way to the conclusion, and we will also train your child in all the technical aspects of writing like vocab, grammar, and sentence structure construction. And of course, we will impart the secrets to writing model compos that stand out from the crowd…

We don't promise 'miracle' improvements, but if your child has a good learning attitude, and is able to apply the concepts taught, he or she has a chance of being one of the top writers in class. (No kidding!) You can see the testimonials on our Facebook page by clicking this link here >>>
https://www.facebook.com/writingsamurai/

Anyway, to get the most out of these model compos, you should study how our students phrase their words, or choose the most effective vocabulary to describe a scene. Observe how they write intros, build up the climax and end the story in unique ways that leave deep impressions on you.

Read. Learn. Apply.

Then practise a couple of times.

Soon, you will get the hang of it; and hopefully one day, we can publish your compositions in the next edition of our model compositions book too.

But for now, just sit back, relax, and enjoy these stories!

Topic: An Unwelcomed Guest

Pictures given: A messy room, a cockroach, a burglar

Humans hate me to the core. They dread me more than the coronavirus. I am the bane of their existence and they will kill me once I am spotted in their house. I am Bay, the disgusting cockroach.

“Hey, I found some delicious biscuit crumbs. Hurry up and carry them back!” I shouted to my friends, feeling over the moon. Gleefully, we scurried back into our hidden lair in a secluded corner of the room.

“Biscuits, bread, sugar, cheese… these will last us for months!” I announced merrily after doing the stock-take. All my families and friends cheered triumphantly.

“Despite the ample food supply, we have to leave our hideout again to hunt for food tonight,” I muttered.

“Why? Don’t you know that each hunt is a risk for us? We might get killed anytime by the humans!” Jo, my sister, protested.

“Yes, I am aware. However, I heard the Ho family is going to have a party today, so there will be a spread of scrumptious delicacies. We must seize this opportunity to collect more food first before resting for two weeks. After tonight, we’ll have a feast. Is this fine with all of you?” I answered, trying to convince everyone to take up my idea.

Everyone exchanged glances with one another and nodded. We hoped that the mission would be smooth and successful.

The full moon shone brightly, accompanied by dazzling stars that blinked through the night. Alas, we did not have the cover of darkness, but beggars cannot be choosers. As usual, a few of us started our scavenger hunt at 3 a.m. Bingo! As expected, there were many food scraps on the floor! We stared at them with glee as saliva slowly dripped out of our mouths.

“Woah, woah, woah! I have never seen so much food before!” I exclaimed excitedly. All of us sprang into action and heaved the morsels back into our hideout. Just as I was about to escape, the room was filled with bright light.

“Oh my gosh! Stupid cockroach!” Mrs Ho shrieked at the top of her lungs once she spotted me.

Instantly, I was scared out of my wits and froze. Why did she suddenly wake up in the middle of the night? Shouldn’t she be asleep? I had no time to waste and fled for my life.

With the fury of an exploding volcano, Mrs Ho grabbed the nearest weapon, a broom, and wielded it like a sabre, trying to hit me dead.

“Die! You dirty roach! You don’t deserve to be here at all! In my house! How dare you? You should be extinct forever!” she shrieked as she chased me around with her weapon.

I tried my best to escape from the jaws of death, using my wings to fly as far as I could. Hopefully, my comrades will not be discovered by her!

Unable to catch me, Mrs Ho was about to give up when an idea popped into her head. She threw the broom on the floor and charged towards the storeroom, grabbing a can of insecticide. Oh no! Is this chemical warfare? Is this the deadly poison that had killed so many of my ancestors?

“Die! You disgusting pest!” Mrs Ho exclaimed, shielding her nose as she squeezed the nozzle relentlessly.

“Looks like it’s true… this is really lethal… I can’t breathe…” I mumbled as my legs threatened to crumple under me. Mustering my last ounce of strength, I finally leapt out of the window.

I did not notice how far I had travelled, but I think it was the furthest I had ever crawled in my life. I arrived at a rubbish dump nearby and collapsed on a trash bag.

For the next few days, I was devastated as I was separated from my beloved family and friends. Will we ever be reunited again? Will they be in danger now that the Ho family has realised that we, the unwelcomed guests, have been living in their house? Tears of sorrow filled my weary eyes as images of my loved ones filled my mind.

Although I was separated from my pillars of support, life has to go on. I found many delectable treats in the trash bags at the garbage dump. I discovered that

actually I was not alone. I made many new friends who welcomed me and I realised that most of us shared the same fate. Even though I was an unwelcomed guest at Mrs Ho's house, at least I was embraced with open arms here. My new friends treated me like family and I was really grateful towards them.

Maybe, this is where we cockroaches truly belong.

Ruixian, P6

Topic: Adapting to Change

Pictures given: A dark alley, A wheelchair, A swing at the playground\

Wheelchair. That horrible metal chassis that chained me to my disability. Wheelchair, preventing me from doing the things I want to do. Wheelchair, robbing me of my childhood.

I hated being handicapped. For one, getting around was impossible, especially in school. With endless flights of stairs and crowded hallways, there was no way for me to get up to my classroom! Before I was wheelchair-bound, I was the most active person in class, running from lesson to lesson or playing catch with my friends. Now, all I can do is just sit by the side and watch the world go by.

Being wheelchair bound was so hard! Why did my life have to be so miserable? Why did the cancer have to pick me? Although I have been in this horrid wheelchair for a year, I have not gotten used to my loss of mobility. In my friends' eyes, I will always be 'that wheelchair girl'.

One day, my class had a new student, and to everyone's surprise, she was confined to a wheelchair too! Maybe she was just as miserable as me, being stuck in a wheelchair and being left out all the time. The teacher assigned the new girl to sit next to me, and once the teacher left we struck up a conversation.

"Hi! I'm Cheryl! Nice to meet you!" the new girl exclaimed. "How long have you been in your wheelchair? I've been in mine for a few years now…it was all because of a spinal injury! What about you?"

Once I heard this, I was slightly overwhelmed and meekly replied, "Well, I've been in my wheelchair for a year, and I had bone cancer so I'm stuck like this for the rest of my life!" I said, forcing a fake smile onto my face.

Cheryl looked at me with a slight frown and asked, "Sorry, am I overwhelming you? I tend to get excited when I meet new people."

I sighed and told her that it was all right. Cheryl had been in a wheelchair for a few years! But she was so buoyant and did not seem bothered by it at all. How does she do it?

During recess, I invited Cheryl to my table and we continued our conversation.

“How do you do it? I mean, you're so cheerful and carefree despite being immobile!” I blurted.

Cheryl looked at me and gave me a warm smile.

“It's all about adapting to change. When I first got my wheelchair, I was really upset. However, I started reading up about handicapped people like me, and soon I realised that getting angry or thinking that life was unfair would get me nowhere. So, I began to remind myself to be grateful for what I have, and that I was not the only one going through all of this. I also talked to my parents about it, and I became calmer.

“Look, I know that being handicapped is difficult, but it's all about how you handle the change,” Cheryl explained.

It was a wake-up call that jolted me out of self-loathing and despair. Never had I thought that I would be crying during recess! Cheryl’s words impacted me a lot, and I knew that I had to change my ways.

At home, I started meditating and reminding myself that I had it in me to survive, even thrive. I spent less time fretting about my problems and more time feeling grateful for my other blessings. I watched many videos about inspiring handicapped people, and followed some of their methods on how to adapt to big changes. One of these was to open up to others and try out new activities, proving to myself that my handicap did not limit my growth.

My family members all commended me, saying that I had become more resilient. More people started becoming my friends and including me in ‘normal kid’ activities. I felt overjoyed and thought, maybe this wheelchair is not that bad after all!

Let's start again. Wheelchair, pushing me to try new things. Wheelchair, teaching me how to adapt to change. Wheelchair, my superpower.

Kathleen Wan, P6

Topic: A Brave Rescue

Pictures given: A helicopter, An ambulance, A life buoy

The sea retreated further than usual, revealing rocks and shells that I had not seen before. Thinking that all was well, I closed my eyes once more and felt the sunshine on my face. Suddenly, a piercing scream rang out, which made me sit up straight in my beach chair. Throngs of people were running helter-skelter away from the sea, breaking the tranquillity of the beach. People were screaming at the top of their lungs…

Just an hour earlier, I was running to the beach with my foldable beach chair under my arm for a relaxing sun-tanning session. Everything seemed ordinary. Families of all sizes were relaxing under the shade of the leafy palm trees, a few children were frolicking happily in the shallow waters, while some others set up a net and started playing volleyball. Nothing bad could possibly happen on such a beautiful day, could it? However, I could not have been more wrong.

I had only closed my eyes for just for a few moments when a piercing scream shook me out of my daydream. Desperate shouts of the dreaded word “tsunami” could be heard in the air. Only then did I turn around, and the sight that greeted me would forever be etched in my mind.

A gigantic wave – taller than a four-storey building, could be seen in the distance and its majestic shadow loomed over the beach. It was bearing straight towards me! My eyes turned as wide as saucers. I whipped around and took to my heels. I knew that I had to find higher ground to escape the wrath of the raging waves. I could hear the roaring of the tumultuous waters growing louder and louder.

It was too late. Being no match for the waves, I was soon swept away. I struggled to grab hold of something but the force from the currents was too strong.

“Someone… save me!” I gasped at intervals, between great gulps of salty and murky water.

Just as I gave up all hopes of survival, I spotted a rescue helicopter several metres above me. I flailed my arms wildly, hoping that the pilot in the helicopter would spot and rescue me.

The pilot manoeuvred the helicopter to approximately two metres above my head. About a minute later, someone from the helicopter who was wearing a harness held by thick, strong ropes was lowered down to pull me up. He held his hand out.

“Come on!” the man beckoned urgently.

Coughing and spluttering, I reached out my hand and I felt a pair of strong arms pulling me into the helicopter.

I lay on the seat in the helicopter, exhausted yet relieved. My eyes were a little red from the water. I was whisked to the nearest hospital for medical treatment. When the helicopter landed on the rooftop of the hospital, they ushered me out. I could not help but take another glance at the helicopter and the people inside it. They were my saviours – heroes who had rescued me bravely without fear. If not for them, I could not have survived the terrifying ordeal.

Kiersten Lim, P5

Topic: Teamwork

Pictures given: A soccer ball, A dragon boat race, A paint brush and paint

Before this incident happened, I did not know what teamwork was. Was teamwork merely about cooperating to win? That was what I always perceived teamwork to be.

“Let the annual Dragon Boat racing competition begin!” the referee announced.

Bang!

The crowd cheered. My team and I took off like the wind. We had been training vigorously for the past six months—in the mornings and evenings, rain or shine. We were all at tip-top condition, eager to win the race.

As Captain John barked out the command with his gruff voice to start paddling, I thrust my paddle forward into the quiet water and pushed it back with all my might. Today was a good day for a dragon boat race. The sky was cloudless, and the weather was excellent.

The air was fizzing with tension, like a can of Coke that had been shaken. When the race began, the spectators erupted into unbridled cheers and they waved their flags wildly. Drumbeats of different rhythms thundered along the river. The sound was almost deafening!

Beside us were our opponents, their dragon boats made of fibrous wood and painted beautifully. As I focused rowing to our team’s drumbeat, my team paddled furiously, remembering our strenuous training and our roles in the team.

Before we knew it, we were ahead of our rivals.

“Yes! We are winning!” Perry, my best friend, who was seated behind me, exclaimed between his laborious breaths.

Suddenly, I felt the air become still and heavy, like a wet towel had draped itself over me. The sky darkened as if something inevitable and malicious was about to happen. Fat drops of rain started pelting down like bullets. My heart skipped a

beat. Is a thunderstorm coming? As if to answer me, wind started blowing ferociously and thunder boomed loudly like a lion's roar. I felt the boat bobbing up and down and realised that the water was getting choppy.

"Continue paddling! Nothing can stop us from winning!" Captain John yelled, and he hit the drum faster and harder as the thunder almost drowned out the beats.

I put my entire body into it. My arms were already aching but the desire to win propelled me to ignore the intense pain.

Splash!

What was that sound? I turned back to see a figure bobbing in and out of the water.

"Hey! Perry fell into the water!" one of my teammates shouted in panic.

As I squinted my eyes, I could see the terror on Perry's face as he struggled to stay afloat in the turbulent river.

"We must save him! Turn the boat around!" Captain John ordered.

That was when a horn was blown to halt the race. Without hesitation, we turned the boat around and started paddling towards Perry. When we reached him, I used my paddle to reach for him while the rest of the team tried to steady the boat in the unruly waters. As I thought he was about to take hold of the paddle, a sudden wave swept him further away from us.

Captain barked his command to move the boat closer to him.

Perry missed again.

We manoeuvred the boat.

He almost caught my paddle.

Captain John grabbed my waist for support while I leaned further out of the boat to reach Perry.

Yes! Perry managed to grab the paddle this time!

As I dragged Perry back onto the boat, a wave of relief washed over me. Perry was finally safe!

We then paddled hard towards the shore. Witnessing what had happened, the onlookers cheered with relief.

After the ordeal, my team and I sat in the sheltered spectator seats, deep in thought with warm cups of tea in our hands. Perry, wrapped in layers of towels, was thanking the team profusely. It was then that I realised what teamwork was about.

Teamwork was not just about winning. It was about working together and helping one another in times of difficulty. It was about leaving no man behind. I was proud that my team had banded together when one of us was in danger. Even though we did not win the race, we had been rewarded with the knowledge that we were a true team who had one another's backs.

Luke, P6

Topic: A Foolish Act

Pictures given: A smartphone, A lit cigarette, A wallet

It was a lazy Sunday, my favourite day of the week. I brushed my teeth and went to the kitchen to eat my breakfast. After that, I plopped down on my bed with my iPad and decided to watch movies for the whole day. I searched up a movie called 'Descendants 2' and tapped on a website.

As soon as I clicked on 'play', a notification flashed across my screen. When I tapped on it, I saw the message, "Congratulations! You are Safari's lucky winner for 1st June! Answer a few questions and you can win a $100 Popular voucher! Click on this link now! https://luckywinner.com.sg."

I could not believe my eyes! When I clicked on the link, there were a few questions to answer. Immediately, a sense of wariness gnawed at my guts and my finger paused above the screen.

In school, our teacher had taught us to never believe notifications or messages claiming to gift us money. Unless we asked our parents, we should never give away our personal details.

Now, I was in a dilemma. I really wanted to answer those questions so I could receive the $100 Popular voucher. However, I was afraid of getting scammed as this message looked suspicious. There was a limited-edition colour pencil set that I had set my sights on in Popular bookstore, but it cost an exorbitant $70. I knew my parents would not let me buy it and I was too scared to ask them about this message. But if I had that money, I could buy it myself! After pondering for a while, I caved in to the temptation and decided to give the questionnaire a go.

The first few questions were about my Safari usage habits. I breezed through them before I was posed a question about my father's phone number. That was followed by a notification that read, "You're almost there!" Brimming with anticipation, I went on to the next question…

"What is your credit card number?"

Again, a sense of uneasiness stirred in me and I hesitated again. Is this really something I should disclose? Below it, the text box read, “Credit card number is only needed for verification.”

I knew I was running the risk of being scammed but I desperately wanted the $100. However, I reasoned that Singapore was such a safe country that the chances of this being a scam should be quite low. Gulping, I snuck into my father’s room, retrieved his credit card, and answered the rest of the questions the best that I could, praying that I would win the voucher.

A while later my father called for me. Thinking that he had received the voucher, I skipped towards him, my heart singing. However, his stone-cold expression made my feet screech to a halt.

He was glaring at me, his brows furrowed so deep a farmer could have seeded them.

He pointed at his computer screen and shouted, “Were you the one who gave my credit card number away? Look what’s happened now!”

His words slapped me in the face. I read the screen and got a shock of reality. It read, “$500 has been charged to your card.” The source of the charge was from an unknown retailer. l I could not believe my eyes! It was really a scam. My suspicions were right all along. I tried begging for his forgiveness, but he dismissed my apologies with a wave of his hand.

“How could you have been so naive, Christine? Just for a colour pencil set? I’m deducting that amount from your savings,” he pronounced.

I had been promised a $100 voucher, but instead $500 was taken away from me! A tear trickled down my cheek.

I could not believe my stupidity. When my mother learned about the entire fiasco, she just shrugged and muttered, “A fool and her money are soon parted.”

That was a harsh lesson that I would never forget.

Devanshi Jena, P6

Topic: Trying Something New

Pictures given: Rock Climbing, Snorkelling Gear, An Apron

I looked up at the huge wall that loomed over me. Taking deep breaths, I put my hands in my chalk bag. “This wall,” I told myself, “is going to be conquered.”

Well, I did not become a professional rock climber overnight; neither did I grow up as one. It all started a few years ago…

“Mum,” I shouted through the cracks of the door. “I’m done with school for the year!” My mother welcomed me with a hug. I placed my schoolbag down, running towards the dining table. The sweet-smelling aroma of homemade fried rice wafted into my nose. I sat down, eager to tuck into a well-deserved meal.

“Sally,” she began with a smile, “since the holidays are here, we think that this is the perfect opportunity to learn something new!” From her tone, I could tell she was excited.

“Mum,” I grumbled, “school is over! Besides, I have computer games to play!”

“Yes, Sally. However, you should still keep an open mind!”

Ugh, I grumbled inwardly.

As I browsed the internet for something new to learn, I came across an advert on a site that read, “Rock-climbing course for beginners!” Perfect!

That very afternoon, my mother brought me to the rock-climbing venue to gear up. Throngs of avid learners congested the tiny room. Our coach, a lady named Mary, instructed us on the right placing of our hands and legs, as well as the “do’s” and “don’ts”. Raring to go, I hurriedly put on my harness.

It was my time to conquer a small, 20-foot wall, as our warm-up. I attached my harness securely to the belay. I began my ascent and the first few steps were smooth-sailing, or so I thought.

“Argh!”

All of a sudden, my foot slipped, and I was dangling in mid-air, held up only by the safety belay. My face became red with embarrassment. A voice below called out, “Hold on to the rope with both hands and I’ll let you down slowly.”

I was soon on firm ground. “What a loser,” I heard a group of girls snickering. “She can’t even get this right.” At that moment, I felt like a failure. Unable to hide my embarrassment anymore, I ran to the toilet, crystal-like tears in my eyes.

“Sally,” I heard someone coming into the washroom. “Are you there?”

I came out of the cubicle I was hiding in and forced a smile.

“Look,” Mary assured gently. “I know you felt embarrassed just now. And the girls weren’t right either. Just suck in up and try again. Anyway, if you have any difficulties, you can always turn to me.”

After saying that, she left. Knowing I had a supportive coach, my hopes were renewed.

In the blink of an eye, three months had passed, and I was making much progress with the help of Mary. I advanced to more challenging walls and it felt great when I conquered them, which now brought me to this current moment...

“You sure you’re up for this?” my mother asked again.

“Yeah,” I assured. I stared at the summit. I was ready.

Thousands of spectators watched my every step. I took a deep breath, recalled Mary’s advice, and placed my hand on the first rock.

In just five minutes, I had conquered this 600-foot wall. Beaming, I descended smoothly as the audience cheered for the new ‘Under 15 Rock-Climbing’ Champion.

I have learnt many things from this rock-climbing journey. Firstly, learning is not just about taking exams or feeling brain-dead after an intensive day of studying. It is also about finding the joy and satisfaction in learning and solving problems outside of academia. In my case, it is mostly about how to reach the top in the fastest and most efficient manner. Secondly, always persevere and try your hardest because that is one of the surest ways to overcome any challenges.

Lastly, there is no obstacle too big to overcome. When there is a will, there is a way. I look back on this journey and realised that all these insights could only be gleaned, because of my decision to try something new.

Anonymous

Topic: A Touching Moment

Pictures given: A piece of cake, hands cupped in a begging position, two people hugging

When I started primary school, I knew a kid who loved to cause trouble. His name was Ah Seng, and he would pick fights every day, play pranks on people, and he would do anything to just get his way. It was only when I was Primary 5 when we realised the truth about him…

It was a regular day at school. My classmates were chatting animatedly to each other before class started.

“Oh no! My wallet is missing!” Jack suddenly cried out.

David and a few other students checked their own bags and to their horror, their wallets had also disappeared into thin air.

Just then, our form teacher, Mr. Lee, strode into the classroom, and hearing all the commotion, he asked, “Good heavens, what is going on in here?’’

When we told him about the situation, he said he would think of a plan but could not promise anything.

The next day, the principal made an announcement. He instructed some of the teachers and some prefects from each class to conduct bag checks. I, as a prefect, wasted no time conducting as many bag checks as I could. At that time, we did not suspect who was behind this, although we started noticing an unusual behaviour in Ah Seng. When we performed bag checks, Ah Seng seemed to break into a cold sweat, appearing very nervous. From then on, we started to monitor Ah Seng whenever we saw him. This continued until one day…

We were getting ready to leave for home when Roy spotted Ah Seng acting suspiciously and whispered to us, “I think he is up to no good. Let’s secretly see what he does.”

We squatted down and peeked through the classroom window. Just then, David spotted Ah Seng taking Tyler’s wallet from under his table. We jumped into action, burst into the classroom, and caught Ah Seng in the act. He dropped the

wallet and stood rooted to the spot, staring at us with a shocked expression. Subsequently, he just burst into tears.

"Sorry… I know it was wrong of me to steal…" Ah Seng whimpered as tears rolled down his cheeks. "But …but … I desperately needed the money. My mother is seriously ill, my father lost his job… and now, we don't have enough money to see the doctor."

We were stunned. Our hatred towards Ah Seng turned into sympathy. "You could have asked us for help," Roy spoke up. "We would have given you the money straightaway."

We nodded in agreement. I took some money out from my pocket and handed it over to Ah Seng…

When we told the teacher about what happened, all of us decided that the right thing to do was to pool some money together and give it to Ah Seng to help his family tide over their temporary difficulties.

Several months later, Ah Seng approached Roy, David and me with a wad of cash in his wallet. He return us the money we had given him.

Smiling, he said, "Thank you so much for helping me. My mother is much better, and my father just got a well-paying job. I am so grateful and touched that you all helped me. Thank you so much!"

Tears of joy and gratitude rolled down his cheeks as he hugged us. It was a touching moment and we have been good friends ever since. As it turned out, forgiving him and showing compassion was the right thing to do.

Titus Leong, P6

Topic: A Foolish Dare

Pictures given: A smartphone, A wallet, A bandaged arm

"Wow! That's so awesome!" George was beaming from ear to ear as he stared at his smartphone's screen.

He was seated on the sofa, watching YouTube videos on his smartphone about a death-defying sport called parkour. He was amazed by the tricks the traceurs pulled off, such as jumping off roofs and scaling the walls of tall buildings. He decided to show the video to his friends the following day, hoping that they would be as excited as he was about these stunts.

The next day, George and a couple of his friends were sitting at a table in the canteen when he whipped out his phone to show them the video on parkour. As the video went on, George boasted that he had been secretly practising those stunts and he was able to perform even the intermediate level tricks. He wanted his friends to think that he was very cool. However, some of his friends shot suspicious looks at him.

One of them, Fred, declared, "Like real! How about we see you do it tomorrow since you are such a dare-devil!"

The boastful wide smile was instantly wiped from George's face.

His face turning pale, he stammered, "S-sure! I'm not afraid!"

That night, George thought hard on how he could execute those tricks without injury. He looked it up on the internet, but it was futile. Every website about parkour emphasised the need for prior training. It was most certainly not a sport for amateurs. As dawn drew closer and closer, George started to panic but he had no choice. He knew that he had made the worst decision of his life. He could not back out at the last minute as that would surely make him the laughingstock amongst his friends.

That afternoon, George's friends dragged a reluctant George up a building after school. Their reactions were a mix of excitement and scepticism when he announced that he was going to jump from one building to the other. When George

saw that he was at least about ten metres above ground, fear made him terribly nauseous. No one in the right mind would jump from that height!

“Jump, you scaredy-cat! Quick! We do not have all day!” demanded Fred.

George was reluctant but he desperately wanted his friends to stop taunting him. So, he closed his eyes and started sprinting to the edge of the building. Whispering a final prayer, he leapt. For a second, he was airborne, and a tiny flame of hope lit in his chest. Perhaps he could make it after all! However, gravity woke him up to reality.

Crunch! As soon as he hit the ground, an excruciating pain exploded through his ankles and legs. He cried in agony while his friends gasped in horror...

When George opened his eyes again, his nostrils stung from the pungent stench of antiseptic. Six pairs of eyes were staring down on him.

His mother’s tear-streaked face brightened as she said, “Finally you are awake!”

George stared blankly at the pristine ceiling, wondering how he had ended up in the hospital. His arm was tightly wrapped in bandage and his legs were suspended from metal wires. Just then, he saw Fred, whose face was mottled red with guilt-ridden sorrow.

“Do you know how panicked we had been when you blacked out?” Fred chided, his voice hoarse from sobbing. “

As George surveyed the concerned faces of everyone, he thought, why did I perform such a foolish act?

After a few weeks of observation, George was finally discharged, and he felt a sense of relief wash over him. He thanked the nurse who had been taking care of him.

“No problem, George,” she replied cheerfully. “It is our job to keep you safe. Hope you are well!”

With the help of his crutches, George hobbled towards the exit of the hospital. He decided not to ever perform such dares again. Even if he could have become the coolest kid in school, fracturing his legs was just not worth it.

Kai Rong, P6

Topic: An Argument

Pictures given: A long queue of people, A traffic jam, Two people arguing

Hi! I am Toby. I belong to my owners, Katie and Max. We live together in a big house, and we are a happy family. But it was not always like this. Once, a big argument brewed and something tragic nearly happened. Read on to find out the juicy details...

That day started out like any other day. I was served my delicious bacon. Those tasty morsels which just melt in your mouth while… Sorry! I got distracted. Back to the story!

While I was munching away, Max received a call from work and left the table. Meanwhile, Katie lifted me onto her lap to pet me and scratch behind my ear, every dog's dream! After a moment, Max stormed into the living room, his face black as a thundercloud.

"Max, what happen-" Katie was about to ask when Max cut her off.

"Just eat!" Max said harshly, stabbing his pancakes with his fork.

"Hey! No need to vent your anger on me!" Katie snapped back.

"Well, who asked you to pester me with your annoying questions?" Max retorted.

Katie looked hurt for a split second before her mood shifted to anger.

"Well, it's bad enough that you don't spend time with me and now you lash out at me like that!"

Max balled his hands into fists. "Well, then what's that stupid dog for?"

Max's words hit me in the face like a ton of bricks. Me? A stupid dog? My little doggy heart throbbed painfully.

Katie hugged me protectively as if she wanted to shield me from the invisible daggers shooting out of Max's mouth.

"Hey! Don't say that about my dog! Anyway, it is a much better companion than you are!" Katie shot volleys of abuse at Max.

I could see the dagger-like words hitting their target as Max's look of defiance faltered. Then, Max built his walls again and delivered the killing blow.

"Well then, let's get a divorce! And you can take that mongrel with you too!"

Max won the battle of words with this final pronouncement.

The floodgates opened. The tears brimming in Katie's eyes gushed down her face like water from a broken faucet and I could feel her heart shattering into a million pieces.

Max was taken aback by what he had just said and immediately apologised, "I am sorry, that was not what I meant. Please don't leave me!"

But the damage had been done.

"So that's what you want? Then fine. I will leave now," Katie whimpered.

She ran out of the living room towards the garage, sobbing loudly. Max stared at her, devastated, as tears began to flow down his cheeks.

He grabbed his hair and muttered repeatedly, "What have I done?"

I stared in exasperation at Max and barked at him, "Go get your girl back!"

Almost as if he could understand my words, Max leapt up from his seat and ran to the garage. Katie was sitting inside the car, bawling her eyes out. They were red and puffy from crying, and she was clutching her chest as she wept. Max's heart broke seeing her like that and he opened the car door gently.

Katie looked up at him and wiped away her tears.

"What do you want?" she asked coldly.

Max grabbed her hand and pleaded, "I am so sorry for what I said, Katie. You were right, I have not been spending enough time with you. I was wrong. You are the most beautiful and kind woman I have met. I was just so frustrated as there have been many issues cropping up at work. Please forgive me!"

Katie eyed him suspiciously and murmured, "Do you really mean that?"

Max nodded.

“Fine, then I forgive you,” Katie whispered, trying not to smile.

Max jumped out of the car and started dancing. Katie laughed, her eyes brightening up again. I barked happily as I saw the wounds in her heart healing. I leapt onto her lap and started licking her happily. Katie chuckled, her face aglow with joy.

To all my fellow friends, dogs, and humans, please do not vent your anger on others. Treasure your friends and your loved ones as you will miss them when they are gone. I hope none of you will ever get into an argument like this. It does not help to resolve anything.

Ang Zi Ting, P6

Topic: Forgiveness

Pictures given: A family photo, A handshake, A girl crying

"Holding grudges never works out in the end," my late mother would always repeat those words like a broken record. I never understood her wisdom until then…

"Hey punk!"

A crowd of students parted as a haughty figure strutted forward. His blonde, sandy hair was styled up like a pop star. Ben wore a grey aviator's jacket. His arms rippled with muscles. Anyone who saw the mischievous glint in his eyes would know that he was not the definition of 'well-behaved'. I knew I was doomed. Ben snapped his fingers. One of his friends rushed forward and grabbed me by the collar. I did not bother to move a muscle. I knew what was going to happen.

Ben smirked. "Time for your daily routine!"

They dragged me to the toilet. I swore I saw some people whip out their phones. Ben and his gang pulled me into a cubicle where the familiar toilet bowl stood in front of me. I could hear the whole world laughing.

"So, any last words?" Ben growled.

Anger boiled in me. Oh, that smug look on his face. One day – just one day, I will wipe it off his dirty mouth! I promised myself. I glared at him but remained silent. Splash! The cold dirty water stung my lungs as a pair of rough hands pushed my head down the toilet bowl…

Thirty years passed by in a blink of an eye...

"Good morning, everyone! Welcome back to another day of work!" the boss of the company announced.

His deep voice seemed to shake the earth. The room fell quiet and all eyes were centred on him. There was a sense of respect that the boss had never felt before. He felt like royalty. Who was this boss? One might ask. That was me. I took a deep breath and started rattling about how everybody should be diligent while doing their best for the company and so on. Every black orb gazed at me intently as I took the spotlight.

"And…" I clapped my hands and the office trembled. "That is the end of my morning speech! Please continue with your work!"

I looked around, feeling pleased with myself.

"Wait!" a soft voice chimed out.

Nicole's brown, straight hair fell to her shoulders. Her warm, brown eyes twinkled.

"We have a new-comer!" she announced.

A small, plump man stood up. His blonde hair was straight and tidy. The newcomer wore a black business suit and long pants. He was exactly the type of person who would greet you every morning while everyone just sulked away. This man radiated friendliness like warm sunshine after a heavy rain. His grin made him look as if he was an oversized baby. I immediately liked him.

"Hello! Welcome to our company! What is your name?" I asked.

"My name is Ben!" the newcomer replied in a cheerful voice.

My heart sank and my expression turned ice-cold. I recognised him! This was the same Ben that criticised me in school, the bully who enjoyed dumping my head into the toilet bowl. My initial warm feelings for him disappeared. Hatred burned in my eyes.

"Get out of my sight, now!" I hollered.

Everyone in my presence jumped, fear in their eyes. Ben shook his head, but he did not look afraid, just disappointed. With his head hung low, he scrambled out of the room. Dull silence filled the room yet again.

Every single day, I tried to make Ben's life miserable. I would holler at him over every small issue and hurled insults at him. Every time I did so, he would just look at me sadly like a pathetic puppy. The more he acted like that, the more I despised him. My grudge for that long-time bullying was an eternal flame – forever feeding off my old hurt and injustice.

One day, Ben came up to me alone. He regarded me those pitiful eyes again. However, I was not buying that.

“What?” I shouted at him in annoyance.

Ben sighed, “I know you still bear a grudge against me. I would never be able to forget what I have done even if I lived for a hundred years.”

So what? I thought. I glared at him.

“Anyway, I want to say… that I’m sorry,” he continued sincerely. “Please forgive me.”

“Just go away.” I rolled my eyes.

Ben gave me one last glance before walking away. I swore I heard him sobbing.

Ben was actually crying? He sounded like an upset child with tears flowing down his face. Out of the blue, my mother’s voice rang in my head.

“Holding grudges never works out in the end.”

Oh my goodness! it has been ages since I have heard that beloved voice. That strong yet peaceful voice... I swallowed the lump in my throat and glanced at Ben. He really has changed. Why was I being so hard on him? I caught sight of my reflection on the office window. My scowling expression took me aback. I had become a monster. I was full of bitterness, just like Ben who had preyed on the weak back then. I could not continue behaving like that. I closed my eyes, took a deep breath, then I looked up.

“Hey, erm Ben?” I croaked out.

Ben turned around. A smile tugged at the corner of his mouth. A strange warmth spread over my once cold heart.

“I forgive you.”

By Gervin Tan, P6

Topic: An Argument

Pictures given: Two people arguing, A storm cloud with lightning, A capsule

Regret was what my mother felt after having a heated argument with my father over their differences in their choices of my secondary school...

On the day I received my stellar Primary School Leaving Examination (PSLE) results, I was delirious with joy. Prancing around the auditorium with my friends who had also done well, we congratulated one another. The months of putting our noses to the grindstones and enduring weekends without computer games had finally paid off. Equally ecstatic, my proud parents beamed from ear to ear.

The initial euphoria quickly died down. The days following the release of the results did not turn out the way I had expected. I anticipated a week of feasting, partying and lying in bed playing my iPad games. Unfortunately, none of these materialised...

My parents had always seen eye-to-eye and rarely argued. They enjoyed a harmonious marriage as they possessed strong conflict resolution skills. However, there was no peace at home as soon as we sat down to discuss my choice of secondary school.

“Qing Wen’s natural choice will be Anglo Chinese School Independent ACS(I) as it is my alma mater. He will be happy in the school as he will stay within the ACS family,” assured my father who was a proud ACSian.

In the firmest of voices, my mother retorted, “I disagree with you. All my friends’ sons go to Raffles Institution (RI). This is the school for the cream of the crop.”

An altercation rapidly ensued. Pointing an accusing finger at my mother, my father claimed that she made her choice for the sake of her pride and to satisfy her desire to keep up with the Joneses.

Raising her hands up in a fluster, she snapped, “I know what is good for my son!”

She went on by highlighting the fact that a two hundred and thirty-five T-scorer with affiliation could easily enrol into ACS(I). One did not need to be very brilliant to get in. That sting hit my father's raw nerve. Refusing to drag out the spat, my father gave her the cold shoulder and stopped speaking to my mother. Deep inside me, I knew that my father wanted me to continue the tradition instead of breaking the mould.

The spat morphed into a cold war. Within the confines of our tiny apartment, my parents pretended that the other person was invisible. My mother was The Invisible Woman and my father was The Martian Man. There was unbearable tension in the air whenever they were at home. I felt hopelessly stuck in between them. I felt insecure even in the sanctuary of my own bedroom. My mother went on strike. When she refused to wash my father's laundry, I had to help. When she refused to cook his meals, I had to call Deliveroo. When she refused to vacuum the floor, I had to struggle with the cumbersome Electrolux.

As the war dragged on, it dawned on me that I had only a few days left to register for my secondary school. I knew I had to intervene...

Coincidentally, it was my birthday and I organised my own birthday celebration involving just my parents. The venue was at Hakumai and we had Omakase dinner.

After dessert was served, I broke the silence and explained earnestly to my parents, "Mummy and Daddy, I have made up my mind. I want to go to ACS(I). Most of my friends who excelled are also enrolling in this school. Mummy, please do not get mad with me. I have thought about this long and hard. I cherish the friendships that I have established over the past six years. I cannot let my efforts go to waste."

My mother gave a weak smile and replied with a twinge of regret, "Qing Wen, I will respect your decision. I was too iron-fisted, wanting to decide everything on your behalf, thinking that it would be the best for you."

Beaming, my father gave her a tight embrace.

In retrospect, though my parents' argument had left me in a quandary, I should have mediated their argument much earlier than let it fester. I could have sat

them down and encouraged a sensible discussion about my choice. Nonetheless, I am glad I had followed my heart and chosen ACS(I).

The best is yet to be!

By Qing Wen

Topic: A Foolish Dare

Pictures given: A Phone, A Cockroach, A Pair of Crutches

An idle brain is a devil's workshop. To this day, I still remember the foolish dare that I still curse myself for accepting out of boredom. Now, I am an absolute laughing stock because of what happened a year ago.

That day, when I was twelve and naïve, I was having lessons in my tuition centre. I hated the teacher; I hated the environment; I hated everything to do with that living hell. That very day, my tuition classmates dared me to do something about it.

I had brought a very genuine-looking rubber cockroach, that my brother had given me, to the centre that day. When Mr Jerry, our English teacher, was drinking coffee elsewhere, I snuck to his desk and put the fake cockroach in his file. When he came back to teach the lesson, he opened his file…

It was priceless! He jumped and almost tripped over his bag. He let out a whimper so pathetic that the entire class burst into hysterical laughter. But our moment of happiness did not last long.

Mr Jerry's face contorted with rage as he boomed, "WHO DID THIS?!''

His eyes seemed to be spewing out poison as he stared accusingly at everyone of us, trying to find signs of guilt. I, as usual, made use of my pretty good acting skills, and pretended to cower in fear with the rest of the class.

"Trisha, was it YOU?'' he hollered. "SEE ME AFTER CLASS!''

For some reason, he knew that I was the one behind all this. Lesson started as per normal, with me almost falling asleep, barely being able to keep my eyes open. I excused myself to wash my face, but when I came back, the class was full of tensed whispers.

"Hey Trisha, you're in trouble…'' Alyssa warned.

"You better watch out…'' Stella said.

“Mr Jerry’s going to throw a real cockroach at you…’’ Nicole muttered.

I shrugged it all off, mustered a stoic expression, and sat down. I was chatting animatedly with my friend Alyssa when…

“SHUT UP TRISHA!’’ Mr Jerry’s voice reverberated throughout the room.

He threw a piece of crumpled paper in my direction. Oh no! Was the cockroach in there? The real live one? In my panic, I let out a small scream, but to my relief, when I opened the piece of paper, I found no cockroach. I laughed it off, and the class laughed with me, but Mr Jerry had more in store for me.

Another crushed piece of paper flew towards me. I laughed nonchalantly.

“What sort of joke is this?’’ I asked, bending down to pick up the supposedly harmless piece of crushed paper. To my horror…

“Aaaaaaaahhhh!’’ I let out an ear-piercing scream for a good 30 seconds.

A real live cockroach crawled out! I was paralysed, I stood rooted to the ground and stared at the flying cockroach while Mr Jerry flashed a wicked grin. I fainted on the spot.

When I regained my consciousness moments later, I was on the carpet of the tuition centre’s floor. Class was already over. I stood up, grabbed my phone from the table, and fled. I did not want to see Mr Jerry after class. I scrambled down the stairs, not bothering to even take the lift.

When I checked my phone notifications later on, two thousand alerts overwhelmed me. I went to one of the links my friend had sent me. The title read: ‘One Hour of Cockroach Screaming Girl’. There was a video of me, screaming again and again, replayed for one hour, and the video was shared 10,061 times.

Whenever I recall that incident, my face still burns with humiliation. I had been dared to play a foolish prank on Mr Jerry, but I did not expect him to play such a cruel prank back on me. He who laughs last, literally laughs the longest.

By Keira, P6

Topic: A Heart-Warming Experience

Pictures given: A birthday cake, A beach, A photo

The sweat, the blazing sun, the heat... The memory of this heart-warming experience was still vivid in my mind. It happened just last weekend…

“Everyone, gather over here now!” Mr Tan demanded.

I barely heard what Mr Tan said as something unpleasant had caught my attention. The entire beach looked like a junkyard! The shore was littered with discarded plastic, unwanted trash, and broken toys. I could not withstand the pungent odour that followed me wherever I went. I wrinkled my nose in revulsion.

“Billy! I said gather over here!” Mr Tan shouted with flared nostrils.

I walked over to him and joined the other students.

“Today we are at the beach to clean up the littler, and make it litter free!” Mr Tan explained.

He split us up into four groups.

“One group will be in charge of picking up items made of paper. The second group will pick up glass bottles, and the third will pick up anything made of metal. Lastly, the fourth group will pick up plastic…”

He distributed three trash bags to each group, and we all got to work.

I felt like I was being heated by a furnace. Even though I was wearing sandals, the hot sand was still burning my feet. I perspired profusely as beads of sweat trickled down my forehead. I felt a stab of jealousy watching the beach goers lying under their beach umbrellas. However, I continued to persevere and pick up as much litter on the beach as I could.

“Keeping the beach clean is everyone’s responsibility!” I kept reminding myself.

To motivate myself as I cleaned up the beach, I hummed a jovial tune I had heard on the radio earlier. “Save my word, save my world today…”

Before long, the other students hummed along. We supported one another and that inspired me to work even harder and it was very satisfying to see the piles of rubbish on the beach slowly disappearing. The clean-up required a lot of effort, so we took breaks in between the cleaning to quench our thirst and satisfy our hunger.

After what seemed like hours, the beach was finally transformed into a pristine stretch of land! There was not a litter in sight. I felt the buzz of achievement as my hard work had paid off!

The sea was rise and fell with its dormant strength. The waves were undulating gently to the shore. I could hear the sea kindling its own symphony. We strolled along the beach, enjoying the grainy sand under our toes, and watching it glow with a newfound glory. Surrounded by a watery wonderland, the beach was drenched in the vibrant hues of the setting sun as an evening breeze playfully tugged at the palm trees, gently shaking their branches.

We rested in the shade as we were completely spent. However, we were filled with pride as we had completed our mission. As I look at the sparkling beach, my heart swelled as I knew that I would never forget this heart-warming experience.

By Kenneth Koh, P6

Topic: An Unexpected Friendship

Pictures: A dog, a school bus, a burger

"Finally school's over!" I chirped as I lugged my heavy school bag back home.

Just then, I noticed a filthy, scrawny, brown dog lingering outside my school gates. It looks abandoned, I thought. I immediately took pity on it and rummaged through my school bag. I fished out some leftover pieces of bread in my lunchbox and tottered towards the pathetic dog.

"Here have some!" I offered, flashing a broad grin at it.

It seemed to have noticed my presence and opened its lifeless eyes. The dog gazed up at me with shimmering eyes for a moment before munching on the bread. I patted it and proceeded back home.

From that day onwards, the same pug would be lying on the ground, waiting for me. Once it caught sight of me, it would wag its tail enthusiastically, jumping up and down. As the days passed, I started finding it a nuisance. Sometimes, it would even trail me back home!

"Stop following me, stalker!" I could not control my frustration and yelled at it.

With my fists clenched, I shot the dog a menacing glare. It licked its paws and stared at me with those sparkling innocent eyes, something I found difficult to resist.

"Stop showing me those pitiful eyes and stop waiting for me!"

There was a note of finality in my words. I quickened my steps and glanced back for a few times, making sure it left me alone.

However, one afternoon, my unfriendly sentiments changed. On that fateful day, I was skipping back home merrily, glad that I had a whole weekend to rest. I was even whistling and singing to myself.

"Hey punk! Where do you think you are going?" a familiar voice called out.

I spun around. To my utter horror, there stood the notorious bully Jack and his gang. My worst nightmare had returned to haunt me.

“Wha..What do you want? I gave you a…all my pocket money la…last week already,” I stammered.

My heart palpitated erratically against my ribcage, as if it would pop out of my chest at any moment.

“A few pennies is not enough, you poor, pathetic kid. Give me your wallet!” he demanded, waving his fist at me threateningly.

“I…I don’t have any mo…money. I …I told my mother a…about you, sto…stop stealing my money!” I stammered as I broke out into cold sweat.

Venom spewed from his lips as he cursed me under his breath. To my horror, Jack then grabbed me by my collar and slammed me onto the ground with a loud thud. I grimaced in agony. His entire gang started heckling and kicking at me. I rolled myself into a ball, trying not to scream in pain.

All of a sudden, the ‘stalker’ dog came rushing towards me. It took a giant leap and clamped its teeth around Jack’s left leg, savagely biting him.

“Ouch! You stupid dog!” Jack struggled to shake him free.

The dog let go but he continued barking furiously at Jack and his gang. Jack’s gang members stepped away from Jack and me. Then like a bunch of cowards, they ran out of sight, leaving Jack alone. Jack was still shaken even after the stray dog had stopped biting him.

“You…you better watch out, I’m going to s…sue y…you!” he stammered and scurried away like a mouse.

“Thanks,” I said to the dog, still traumatised by everything that had just happened.

My hero licked my bruised knee in a comforting manner.

“By the way, I shall name you Rusty from now onwards!” I grinned at it.

Rusty barked excitedly at its new name and pranced around.

After saving me from the bullies, I decided to adopt Rusty. We played together and even slept in the same room, becoming as thick as thieves. Our relationship illustrated the fact that the best friendships can be formed under the most unlikely circumstances.

By Oh Yan Lin, P6

Topic: Being a Leader

Pictures given: A group of hands overlaying one another, A pair of hands clapping, A medal

"Class! Welcome to the Interclass Team Bonding Event! You will be in groups of 5 and you have to go through a series of tough obstacles. You must learn to work together and listen to instructions well. Good luck! Now, please go to your assigned teams," the organiser announced.

I darted towards the cone with my team's name stuck on to it. I prayed for teammates who were athletic. The students all searched for their respective teams while I waited in anticipation. When I saw a few students in my team whom I was unfamiliar with, I got worried as they appeared rather unfriendly. However, I remembered not to judge a book by its cover.

I introduced myself to my teammates and encouraged everyone to introduce themselves too. I also asked some casual questions and inquired about their backgrounds. Once we warmed up to one another, they were not so hostile to me or the other teammates anymore. We tried to get ourselves energised and we took sips of water before the race. However, I realised that my team was still not motivated enough. I had to find a way to get them excited.

Based on our casual conversations earlier, I had a feeling my team would enjoy eating pizza and ice cream.

I turned around to face my them and said, "Come on guys! Let's give this our best shot. I really want to win! If we win, I promise to treat the entire team to pizza and ice cream! Mark my words!"

Their faces lit up and they nodded enthusiastically.

"Yeah let's do it!"

"We can win this race, guys!"

Their spirits were lifted. I turned around and focused my attention on the obstacle course in front of me. I could feel the tension in the air.

Bang!

The starter gun went off. All 10 teams rushed forward in a flurry of activity. Everyone was running, swinging, and dodging. In one of the obstacles, we had to leap over make-shift rocks. I lost my footing and slipped. I landed hard on the ground and a burst of pain shot through my leg.

“Argh!” I cried out.

One of my teammates, Josh, hoisted me up to my feet as the rest continued down the course, trying to pull ahead.

Josh and I darted after them, closing the gap. When we caught up, they all checked if I was fine before continuing. Then, there was an obstacle in front which had one of our teammates, Brandon, frozen to the spot.

We had to swim across a small stream to get to the other side. Brandon had a phobia of water. The rest of us tried reassuring him that it would be alright, and that nothing would go wrong. I told the rest to go on first as I comforted Brandon. I offered to go with him and help him to cross the stream. He took a deep breath before nodding in agreement. I grabbed his hand while we waded and swam across the stream. Josh and one of the teammates pulled us out from the other bank. We breezed through the rest of the obstacles without a hitch.

As we raced to the finish line, we were neck and neck with a strong competitor

“Come on! We’re almost there!” I urged my teammates to sprint faster.

All of us crossed the finish line a second before the other team, winning by a hair’s breadth. We were on the top of the world! I collapsed onto the ground, breathless. We grinned from ear to ear as we received our trophies to a resounding applause. True to my words, I treated the entire group to pizza and ice cream.

“Rhysand, you are definitely a born leader!” the entire group exclaimed.

“No guys, it was a team effort.” I shrugged off the compliment and smiled.

Inez Chua, P6

Topic: Learning a New Skill

Pictures given: A computer, A frying pan, A boy learning martial arts

"Today, I will be teaching you how to use PowerPoint on a computer so that all of you will be able to work on your projects and present them to the class," my teacher, Mrs Tan, said. Animated chatter filled the air.

"Does she think we are in primary one? It's obvious that we already know how to use PowerPoint!" my best friend, Mabel, muttered to me.

All my classmates started complaining about how they already knew how to construct a PowerPoint presentation. However, I looked down, trying to avoid making eye contact with anyone. It seemed like I was the only one who did not know how to use PowerPoint. Although our teachers had briefly taught us the basic skills in Primary One, I did not manage to understand anything and ended up relying on my friends to help me finish the work. For three years, I had no further exposure on how to use PowerPoint to make a presentation. After all, I was not interested in acquiring such a skill.

"First of all, I want everyone to log in to your computers," Mrs Tan told the class.

I took what felt like an eternity to type in my username and password, just so that I could log into the computer. By then, most of my classmates had already logged in and were tinkering with the software.

"Class, look at the screen. Click on this button over here and choose a layout you want by clicking the next button here," Mrs Tan said as she demonstrated the steps to the class.

I did as I was told but I was confounded by the myriad of layouts I could choose from. Mrs Tan then taught us how to insert a new slide. I had a hard time trying to figure out where the buttons were. I was also struggling to hold the mouse properly. Before I could even insert the new slide, Mrs Tan proceeded to tell us how we could type in words. Trying my best to keep up, I clicked on the first slide according to her instructions. She told us to click on the text box twice before deleting the standard text and adding our own text. She also told us that we could change the colour and fonts

of our texts simply by clicking some buttons on the toolbar. Again, I struggled to keep up. I stared dumbly at the large number of options to choose from.

Snapping out of my stupor, my fingers fumbled on the keyboard as I typed some words into PowerPoint. After that, I was able to change colour and font. How cool!

"Are you actually following what Mrs Tan is saying?" Mabel whispered to me upon seeing me trying out some PowerPoint features.

I nodded in embarrassment before glancing at her screen. She was already on Google, promptly researching on the project topic.

Mabel looked back at me and said, "I'll teach you instead."

I nodded gratefully and thanked her.

She explained to me how PowerPoint worked in detail. Mabel taught me how to navigate my presentation, create a beautiful PowerPoint template, and preview my presentation slides. In addition, she also taught me how to add transitions between the slides as well as the pictures. I thanked her for the umpteenth time after she gave me that short crash course on PowerPoint. Mabel beamed brightly.

She asked patiently, "Shall we work on the project now?"

"We should," I replied confidently before proceeding to help with researching the project.

I was grateful to have Mabel as a friend. If not for her, I would not have learnt how to use PowerPoint on the computer! Due to Mabel's guidance, I have become competent at using the software and even enjoyed creating presentations. Both of us had our eyes glued on our computer screens, fingers typing away as Mrs Tan droned on like a broken record.

That was how I gained a valuable skill that would help me in the future!

By Tze Yen, P6

Topic: A Courageous Act

Pictures given: A medal of valour, A burning house, A life buoy

"Help! Help!" John wanted to scream.

However, the words just refused to come out. He kicked and thrashed in the choppy waters, but everyone else was just oblivious to the fact that a life was about to end here. He could not even open his mouth to breathe, because if he did, the water would gush in.

Finally, John realised it. He could not make it out alive. He sighed to himself. Looking at all the other people at the shore or the shallow waters, he wished more than anything that he was one of them, before he had plunged into the water, defying his parents' instructions. However, it was too late now. He closed his eyes and gave up trying to stay afloat, letting the currents consume him.

"Keep treading water!"

Suddenly, John heard someone holler just as he was about to deplete the last ounce of oxygen in his body. Fighting off the darkness that was beginning to encroach his field of vision, he forced himself to start kicking again. Relentlessly, he struggled until he was near the surface of the water again.

At the brief moments in which John's head was bobbing above the water's surface, he caught sight of a man waving frantically at him, holding a lifebuoy. Emblazoned on his bright orange shirt was the word 'Lifeguard'. There was hope for John!

With a grunt of effort, the lifeguard threw the lifebuoy into the water. It landed with a splash, but it was not within John's reach. John could not reach it, although it was so tantalisingly close. John's arms and legs were getting tired, and he knew they could not help him stay afloat much longer. He looked at the lifeguard, pinning all his hope on the man.

When the lifeguard found out that John could not reach the lifebuoy, he knew what he had to do. Sucking in a huge ball of air, he dived into the water. With

powerful strokes, he swam towards the boy, gradually closing the gap between them. Silently, he prayed that John would not lose hope.

After what seemed like an eternity, the lifeguard reached John. He grasped the child's arm and towed him toward land. Knowing that he was going to be safe soon, John closed his eyes again, and promptly lost consciousness.

When John woke up, he found himself in a strange room. As his vision focused, he could finally comprehend where he was. A hospital room. He looked around at all the worried faces looking down at him from his bedside. His parents, his friends, and finally… the man who risked his life to save him - the lifeguard. John would never forget the courage he had shown when he saved John's life.

Wei Zhen, P6

Topic: An Argument

Pictures given: Two people arguing, A storm cloud with lightning, A capsule

I had been standing here for over an hour now. It was noon and the scorching sun beat on my bare neck without any mercy. I regretted wearing this long-sleeved dress. I was literally being roasted alive in it. I could feel beads of sweat sliding down my back. Without a doubt, the back of my dress was already smeared with sweat stains. Furthermore, my stiletto heels were killing me. But I could not give up. Not just yet.

The year was coming to an end. Thus, one of the Gucci outlets in Singapore was having a year-end sale, with everything 75% off! Upon hearing that, I wasted no time and dashed off to the nearest outlet at a speed that would have made Usain Bolt proud. Huffing and puffing, I arrived at my destination, only to find a long queue that snaked down the street. Crestfallen, I sighed at the huge turnout but obediently went to the back of the queue. There were probably a few hundred people in line ahead of me. Feeling the sun's glare, I applied a layer of sunscreen. This was going to be a long wait!

After two hours in queue, I felt like I was in hell. The sun was at its peak now, burning in its full glory. The queue was inching forward at the pace of a grandma snail. When I glanced back to my original spot, I was utterly horrified to find that I had only moved forward by about one metre. One metre! Two hours!

Just then, the lady in front of me seemed to have had enough. She strode away from the queue, then disappeared around a corner. Grinning in triumph, I mentally patted myself on the back for being so resilient. As I stepped forward, I noticed a plastic bottle on the floor in front of me. I kicked the trash away and moved up the queue. Progress!

About ten minutes later, the same lady was back again, with a cup of bubble tea. Without a word or gesture, she rudely squeezed in front of me. She then scrolled through her phone while sucking up bubble tea pearls through a fat straw, as if nothing just happened. My jaw dropped open wide at the nerve of her actions. Anger

and incredulity boiled inside me. My nostrils flared and I could feel my arms trembling with rage. Breathe, I told myself. Inhale, exhale…inhale, exhale…But it was no use. Once I felt like I was going to erupt like a volcano, I tapped her shoulder hard.

“Excuse me, may I know why you cut my queue?” I tried to keep my voice even.

At first, she looked at me in surprise, then she shook her head, furrowed her brows, and turned away from me again.

“Look, please go to the back of the line if you want to queue.” I tried again.

“I was here just now!” the lady protested.

“But you went away!” I retorted, not caring about politeness anymore.

“Yes, but I put my bottle here, so –’

“That does not count. You still cut the queue,” I interrupted.

With that, she began shouting incoherent Mandarin at me while waving her hands about. With her spittle flying in my face, I clenched my fists. Who did she think she was? A child throwing a tantrum behaved better than her! As she ranted on and I on, I became more incensed. So, she wants to argue? Well, two can play this game. I shoved my fingers in her face and started telling her off. When she did not back down, I snarled and stared her into the ground. She responded by hitting me. She rained blows after blows on me and I returned the gesture. We scratched, slapped, cursed, and tugged at each other’s hair.

Things were about to get ugly if not for the security guard that pulled us apart. Staring at us sternly in the eyes, he ordered us to either get lost or queue at the back of the line. Ignoring the gawking from the other people in the queue, I brushed myself off, and stalked to the back of the line, seething with anger. The other lady left in a huff.

After two more torturous hours, it was finally my turn. Sighing in relief, I smiled eagerly at the shop staff. However, before I could make my request, he cut me off.

“I’m sorry Miss, we’re all sold out today,” he said apologetically.

Hearing that, my heart plummeted into a dark pit.

“Not…not even… one bag left?” I stuttered, hoping for a miracle.

The staff just shook his head and gave me a piteous smile.

Devastated, I slunk away. I arrived home with an aching back, sunburnt, sore feet, and no Gucci items. All because of one dumb argument.

Zi Qing, P6

Topic: Being Disrespectful

Pictures given: A paper plane, A boy sitting outside the principal's office, A signboard for 'priority seats'

"So, you're the new teacher?" the principal asked as he eyed me warily.

I nodded my head enthusiastically, eager to make a positive first impression. I was quite a short lady, so the principal towered above me a bit menacingly. His eyes scanned my petite figure from head to toe again, his bushy brows forming a frown. I drew myself to my fullest height and tried to look confident. After a moment, he grunted.

"Follow me," he said before striding out of his office.

Minutes later, we arrived at a classroom. On the door there was an old sign that read "Class 6E". My new class. There was a torrent of noise pouring out from the classroom. Oh no… I could never control a rowdy class. Perhaps they are just excited, I comforted myself. However, the ruckus did not seem to faze the principal. His air of nonchalance implied that this was an everyday situation. My heart sank a little. Without any explanation, he pushed the door open and stepped into the classroom.

Instantly, there were several shouts.

"The baboon is here!"

The scraping of chairs against the floor filled the air. Then, silence. The principal gestured for me to come in with a lazy flick of his hand. I swallowed. Hesitantly, I shuffled meekly into the classroom.

The moment I set foot in the class, murmurs started again. The principal rolled his eyes in exasperation and strode over to the teachers table. Without warning, he picked up a metal ruler lying on the teacher's table and slammed it onto the table.

Bang!

"SILENCE! I will have silence!" the principal roared, spittle flying out of his opened mouth.

His sudden outburst almost made me jump out of my skin in fright. But this did not have the same effect on the students. Now it was their turn to roll their eyes.

“Here he goes again…” I heard a student mutter as the principal launched into a lengthy speech of how important respect was in the school.

But it was the last line that really shocked me.

What he said was, “Remember, all of you disrespectful rats are nothing! Nothing at all!”

I was moderately outraged. As an educator, all students are like precious pieces of jade waiting to be polished by me. How could the principal just insult them like that? And to think he himself was lecturing them about respect! The students were apparently used to such foul behaviour too. They responded by sending him off with a chorus of raspberries.

As soon as the principal was out of earshot, there was a visible change in the class atmosphere. Many of the students began chatting while the others whipped out their mobile phones which, of course, were not allowed in school. Paper planes cruised around the classroom. The noise level was starting to escalate. Uh oh. I had to do something fast.

“Everyone please return to your seats,” I blurted out.

I cringed when I realised my tiny high-pitched voice could barely be heard over the commotion the class was making. The few students who noticed looked at me defiantly.

“Why should we do what you say?”

“Yeah, you’re just another oh-so-mighty teacher who knows all about respect!”

“Why should we respect you when you’re not going to treat us with any?”

As I stared open-mouthed at those rebellious pupils, a light bulb suddenly lit up in my head. Immediately, I understood why they were so defiant and rude. Perhaps the reason they were so rowdy was because they already had a reputation for being delinquents. As a result, they were always treated with less respect. Thus, they did not bother to respect other people either. Realising this, my heart ached for all these poor

children. I was going to treat them with the respect they deserve no matter what! But how would I make them listen to me? Then, I had my second brilliant idea of the day.

I strode over to the whiteboard. With my marker, I wrote these words in bold: “Learning point of the day- EVERYONE should be treated with respect.”

The students seated in the front row took notice. Some simply turned away, but others seemed interested and alerted their friends. A spark of hope lit up in my heart. It was working! As murmurings of the statement written on the board spread through the class like ripples on water, that spark turned into a flame. Of course, nothing was perfect and there were a handful of students who still refused to acknowledge my presence. But now that I had most of the class’ attention, I could begin my lesson.

“Good morning everyone, I’m Miss Grace, your new teacher. And today, I will talk to you all about respect. Now, do all of your teachers treat you with respect?”

I was answered with a series of, ‘no’s; and head-shaking. My heart ached again. I carried on.

“But do you think you deserve to be respected?”

This time, silence. Seeing my students so unconfident about themselves, I could not help but feel immense pity for them.

“Of course, you deserve respect! Everyone, no matter old or young, rich or poor, powerful or powerless… deserves respect. Most of you who are facing me, I thank you for your attention. But to the few of you who are not, I respect your choice too.”

At this, the few students who had their backs turned towards me immediately turned around, their cheeks blushing.

Then, a student asked me, “Miss Grace, why are you so nice to us?”

I smiled at her and replied, “Like I said, everyone deserves respect. But you must be the first one to show respect. You must first treat others like how you want to be treated.”

After my little speech, the class warmed up to me quickly. We chatted like a bunch of old friends and I found out that they were all actually really lovely children, just misunderstood. A few of them were talented in various areas too! All too soon, it

was time for me to go to my next class. When I stood up to leave, everyone tried to persuade me to stay longer. Seeing their change of attitude in this short one hour really warmed my heart and I smiled at my students fondly.

"Thank you and goodbye Miss Grace!" they chorused, their backs straighter and voices louder than any of the 'top classes' that I had taught.

As I studied every beaming face, I saw their respect for me, shining in their eyes.

By Zi Qing, P6

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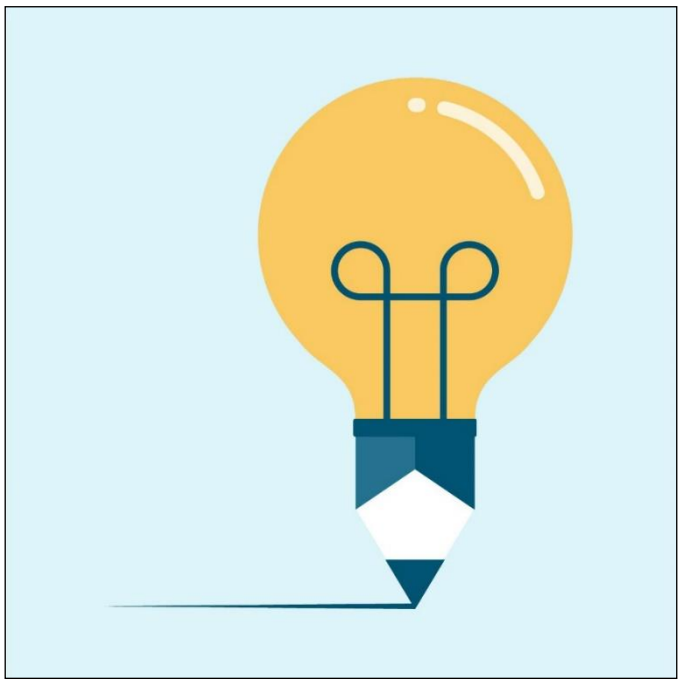

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